

Password Standard

Status: Complete

Document Control

Field	Value
Owner	Security Officer
Version	1.0
Effective Date	2026-08-17
Next Review	2027-08-17 (Annual)
Category	Identity & Access Management
Related Documents	Information Security Policy; Access Control Policy; MFA Standard

Purpose

Defines minimum password/passphrase requirements for accounts still using passwords as a factor of authentication.

Scope

All accounts not exclusively protected by passwordless or federated authentication.

Policy Statements

- 1. Minimum Length** — Passwords are at least 14 characters for standard accounts and 16 characters for privileged accounts.
- 2. Length Over Forced Complexity** — Length and passphrase use are prioritized over forced complexity rules that encourage predictable substitutions, consistent with current NIST guidance.
- 3. Compromise Response** — Passwords are reset immediately upon suspected or confirmed compromise and are screened against known-breached password lists.
- 4. Storage** — Passwords are never stored or transmitted in plaintext; only salted, hashed storage is permitted.

Roles & Responsibilities

- **Executive Management:** Approves this standard, allocates necessary resources, and accepts residual risk.
- **Security Officer:** Owns this standard, maintains it per the Review Process, and coordinates enforcement.

- **IT / System Owners:** Implement and maintain the technical controls this standard requires.
- **All Personnel:** Comply with this standard and report suspected violations to the Security Officer.

Enforcement

Violations of this standard may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination, and, where applicable, civil or criminal liability. Deviations must be requested and approved per the Exception Management Policy.

Review & Maintenance

This standard is reviewed at least annually and following any material change to the organization's risk profile, regulatory obligations, or a significant security incident, per the Review Process.

Version History

Version	Date	Author	Summary
0.1	2026-08-17	Draft	Initial draft produced through the 10-step production pipeline.
1.0	2026-08-17	Published	Approved and published standard.